MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps and Cloud Infrastructure | QA Automation Background

Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines and Kubernetes-based test environments. Built and improved delivery tooling across three product teams, reducing average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and CI runner costs by about 30%. Developing further toward DevOps and cloud infrastructure through personal k3s, GitOps and Terraform projects; professional infrastructure experience includes Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster and namespace-level access.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health, 2023-2024

- Built a GitLab CI workflow to deploy a short-lived application, PostgreSQL and seeded-data environment for each merge request using Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Configured automatic environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams review features and run end-to-end tests in the environments.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health, 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into their own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal, 2024-2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS; provisioned a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform and used Ansible at a basic level.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health, 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the leading offenders.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021-Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Built ephemeral test environments for merge requests using Docker Compose and later Helm charts on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for test-data seeding into PostgreSQL.
- Wrote the internal guide to how the CI system works, used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.

- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd Line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SKILLS

Infrastructure and Delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access at work; k3s homelab), Terraform (personal project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring and Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Programming and Scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Linux, Git, Hetzner VPS; AWS EC2 and S3 basics through personal learning

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level, 2019
Studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA); exam booked for January 2027. Not yet certified.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)